registration of 'fingerprint' and 'other identifying information when applying for broadband internet packages and mobile services', which can be monitored for security reasons. In essence, the security state through the National Database Registration Authority (NADRA) has digitized citizens' identification data where all mobile accounts are connected to this data with the security state able to monitor citizens' online and offline activity without any effective checks and balances.

In relation to anti-military statements online, the Federal Investigation Agency (FIA) has been working with its Counterterrorism Department (CTD) to track down social media users who have been critical of the army. As of May 2017, it 'has identified dozens of suspects involved in what it calls an "organised" campaign against the country's armed forces on social media' (Wasim and Tahir 2017). However, as identified by an FIA agent, the cybercrime division lacks 'modern equipment to deal with such offences'. Furthermore, opposition parties had also accused Nawaz Sharif's government of abusing the law to target its party supporters, especially given that '23 Pakistan Tehreek-e-Insaaf (PTI) supporters were detained and threatened with action under' PECA 2016 (Al Jazeera 2017). The arrests further included one individual arrested 'for sharing a satirical picture of Prime Minister Nawaz Sharif', and journalists complaining of being harassed and threatened under this law. According to a 2017 report by Harvard's Berkman Klein Center for Internet & Society, Pakistan is among seven countries in the world that 'pervasively filter political content', the others being China, India, Indonesia, Saudi Arabia, Uzbekistan and Yemen (Clark et al. 2017). The website of the MQM was banned in August 2016 by the Pakistani government after its leader was accused of delivering 'an "anti-Pakistani" speech' (Freedom House 2017, p. 9). According to Freedom House (2017), 'political dissent and secessionist movements in areas including Baluchistan and Sindh province have been subject to systematic censorship for years' (2017). In 2018, after the PTM gained momentum across Pakistan, the security state started its crackdown on online publication of newspaper articles by journalists, as well as forcing a news channel, Geo News, to go offline for its coverage of PTM (Al Jazeera 2018). Geo News had issues with the security state in the past, being forced off the air for its criticism of Pakistan's army. The moral policing of the population is also evident in pornographic sites being banned. Freedom House (2017) highlights how in the beginning of 2016 alone PTA blocked '429,343 supposedly pornographic websites' without publicizing either 'the list' or the vetting process. Often such measures also impact websites that provide sex education, further policing individual behaviour through such actions (Freedom House 2017, p. 10).